

This Month's DVD Contents

This month's DVD brings a collection of software that contains both design and simulation tools, along with utility software, to enable an easier design process. It also has a free SCADA tool for you to try

SNEHA AMBASTHA

Altium Designer 15

Altium Designer is a useful EDA software package used for PCBs, FPGAs and embedded system design. It also works with associated libraries and release management automation tools. This is the latest version of this software and comes equipped with many advanced features, such as high-speed signal pairing with xSignals, incremental data exchange (IDX) mechanical computer aided design (MCAD) integration support and IPC-2581, and Gerber X2 support.

XCircuit

XCircuit is used to draw electrical circuit diagrams and related figures with a publishable quality. It also produces circuit netlists through schematic capture. It regards all circuits as inherently hierarchical and provides both hierarchical PostScript output and hierarchical SPICE netlists for these. Circuit components are saved in and retrieved from libraries that are fully-editable. It is flexible enough to be used as a generic program for drawing just about anything and is competitive with powerful programs such as xfig.

iqr

iqr helps users create and run simulations of large-scale neural networks. It provides a means to design complex neuronal models graphically, and to visualise and analyse their properties online. It is very flexible and requires very little time for simulation, enabling control of real-world devices in real-time.

Popular resources

- 7Zip-Version 9.35 (file archiver)
- Java Runtime Environment. Version 8.0.250.18 (runs programs written in Java programming language)
- VLC. Version 2.1.5 (media player)
- Opera. Version 26.0.1656.32 (web browser)
- Free Download Manager. Version 3.9.4 (file download manager)
- Thunderbird. Version 31.1.0 (e-mail application)
- Mozilla Firefox. Version 33.1 (web browser)
- Apache Open Office. Version 4.1.1 (open office)
- GPM Clam (antivirus)

S.E.E.R. 2

S.E.E.R. 2 is a full-featured SCADA or historian or aggregate analysis system that has been developed to work as a front-end for mod_openopc. It has been written in pure PHP (an HTML 4.01 transitional) and is driven by web based user interface for universal deployment.

BSch3V

BSch3V is a schematic capture program for Windows 7 or 8. Particularly known as Basic Schematic, BSch 3V is the third version of this software that includes only basic functions to simplify operations. Its package contains BSch3V schematic capture (version 0.82.01), LCoV component library editor (version 0.82.01), PL3W parts list generator (version 0.81.10), NL3W netlist generator (version 0.81.10), NUT3W automatic numbering software (version 0.82.01), CE3Search searching utility for CE3 files (version 0.81.10), a component library and source code.

Toped IC-layout editor

Driven by a built-in script interpreter, Toped is a cross-platform IC-layout

editor that supports GDS, OASIS and CIF formats. The project is under active development. It has a script designed to code and facilitate layout generation and is also used for configuration. The project uses the full power of OpenGL in terms of speed as well as an unrestricted number of colours and fill-patterns.

PPMScope

PPMScope is a do-it-yourself PIC-16F877A microcontroller-oscilloscope that runs with a 20MHz clock. It has an open source design. Its bandwidth is lower than a commercial scope, so its use is limited to signals of 500kHz and below. It has a maximum sampling rate of 1MHz, with 5MHz equivalent sampling mode.

G-code for RepRap

This is an interpreter for G-code language that allows you to perform human-machine interfaces (HMI) related to robotics tasks. It can control a three-axis Cartesian positioning system (for a CNC milling machine) with electronics compatibility to RepRap project. ●

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